IV. Plants and their habitat

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Plants grow almost everywhere on Earth i.e. on land (terrestrial plants) and in water (aquatic plants). The plants adapt to their surroundings and hence have special characteristics based on their habitat.

The natural home of a plant is called its habitat. Plants make suitable adjustment with their surroundings to meet their requirements. This is known as adaptation.

Terrestrial or Land Plants

The plants that grow on the land are of different habitats such as deserts, plains, mountains and forests. Let us learn about the adaptation of different land plants.

Plants in Desert

These plants grow in hot, dry and sandy places. Deserts get very less rainfall and experience high temperature. Hence, there is scarcity of water. Let us see how these plants have adapted to this habitat.

- Leaves are changed to spines to reduce the loss of water.
- The stem is green and fleshy. They store water and produce food.
- These plants have a long root that goes deep into the soil.

E .g., Opuntia, Date Palm and Aloe vera.



Opuntia



Date Palm



Aloe vera

Plants on Mountain

These plants grow in cold and freezing places. There is a cool weather in mountain. Let us see how these plants have adapted to this habitat.

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